

Extraction Micro-Survivor — Game Design Document (GDD)

1. High-Concept Overview

Game Summary

Extraction Micro-Survivor is a fast-paced, top-down arena shooter where the player survives escalating waves of enemies for three minutes, then attempts a high-risk extraction. Runs last 3–5 minutes, and successful extraction rewards currency used to unlock permanent upgrades.

Core Fantasy

- A lone operative dropped into a hostile zone.
- Survive long enough to extract.
- Every run is a gamble: risk death and lose everything, or extract early and bank rewards.

Core Pillars

- Fast, responsive combat
 - Short, addictive runs
 - High-risk extraction tension
 - Simple but meaningful progression
 - Minimal content, maximum replayability
-

2. Gameplay Loop

Moment-to-Moment Loop

1. Drop in
2. Fight waves
3. Survive until extraction appears
4. Reach extraction zone
5. Hold for 5 seconds
6. Extract and earn currency
7. Buy upgrades
8. Repeat

Run Duration

- Three minutes until extraction appears
- Five-second extraction channel
- Optional: stay longer for bonus currency

Failure Condition

- Death results in losing all run currency
-

3. Player Systems

Movement

- WASD movement
- Smooth acceleration
- Top-down camera follow

Weapons

All weapons are hitscan.

- Pistol: balanced and accurate
- Shotgun: close-range burst
- SMG: high fire rate, low accuracy

Shared assets:

- Muzzle flash
- Bullet impact
- Sound effects
- Recoil animation

Health System

- Fixed player health
 - No healing during runs
 - Damage from enemy contact
-

4. Enemy Systems

Enemy Types

Basic Chaser

- Moves directly toward the player
- Deals contact damage
- Low health
- High spawn rate

Elite Chaser

- Larger and faster
- Higher health
- Spawns periodically

AI Behavior

- Simple seek behavior
- No pathfinding

Spawner

- Spawns enemies in rings around the arena
 - Spawn rate increases every 30 seconds
 - Spawn cap to maintain performance
-

5. Extraction System

Extraction Trigger

- Extraction zone appears at the three-minute mark.

Extraction Zone

- Circular glowing area
- Player must stand inside for five seconds
- Taking damage resets the timer

Rewards

- Currency awarded only on successful extraction

6. Meta Progression

Currency

- Earned only on extraction
- Used to unlock permanent upgrades

Upgrade Tree (Six Nodes)

- Damage +10%
- Fire Rate +10%
- Move Speed +10%
- Dash Charge +1
- Extraction Bonus +10%
- Pickup Radius +10%

Upgrade Screen

- Single page with simple buttons
-

7. UI and UX

HUD

- Health bar
- Ammo count
- Timer
- Extraction indicator

Menus

- Main Menu: Play, Upgrades, Quit
 - Pause Menu: Resume, Quit
 - Run Summary: Currency gained and upgrades available
-

8. Art Direction

Style: Low-Poly Hard-Shadow Minimalism

- Flat colors
- Simple shapes
- Hard shadows
- Minimal textures
- High contrast readability

Color Palette

- Arena: dark navy or charcoal
- Player: cyan or white
- Enemies: red
- Extraction: gold

Visual Effects

- Additive muzzle flash
 - White hit flash
 - Red enemy pop
 - Simple circles for impacts
-

9. Audio Direction

Sound Effects

- One gunshot per weapon
- One enemy death sound
- One hit sound
- One extraction sound

Music

- One looping track
 - Tension-building synth
-

10. Technical Scope

Engine

Unity

Systems to Implement

- Player controller
- Weapon system
- Enemy AI
- Spawner
- Extraction system
- Currency and upgrades
- UI flow

Performance Targets

- 60 FPS
 - Fewer than 200 enemies on screen
-

11. Content Limits

- One arena
 - One enemy and one elite variant
 - Three weapons
 - Six upgrades
 - One extraction mechanic
 - One music track
 - No bosses
 - No procedural generation
 - No inventory
 - No crafting
 - No story
 - No cosmetics
 - No multiplayer
-

12. Roadmap

- Days 1–2: Core systems
- Days 3–4: Weapons and extraction
- Days 5–6: Meta progression and UI
- Day 7: Juice

- Days 8–14: Optional polish and Steam page
-

13. Steam Page Positioning

Short Description

A fast-paced extraction roguelite where every run lasts 3–5 minutes. Survive waves, reach the extraction zone, and escape with your loot or die and lose everything.

Tags

- Action Roguelite
- Top-Down Shooter
- Extraction Shooter
- Minimalist
- Survival